

playing terrorists, the roles are reversed, of course, so your aim would be to hold hostages, successfully set off bombs, escape from an area or assassinate the VIP.

It's as simple as it sounds—these game modes are all you'll ever need, coupled with the many different maps available. The game went far beyond being just another *Half-Life* mod, and has spawned a following of its own. It is, in fact, perhaps still the most widely played multiplayer game in India.

What makes this game so cool is the realism factor: when playing a game with a group of team mates, if you're gunned down, you don't automatically re-spawn at a predefined area like in most other multiplayer FPSes; instead, you just sit around and watch until all the terrorists or anti-terrorists are killed and the round is over. This makes for exciting gameplay as the value of your life is very obvious, and no-one wants to get killed first. This forces players to use a lot more stealth and strategy than in any other multiplayer game.

Since you play as a team, and not just for yourself, you have a chance of winning more money, and simultaneously better weapons as you keep winning rounds. This, however, can be a drawback if one team wins, say, four or five rounds in a row, as they are then put at a pretty unfair advantage in terms of firepower, and chances are the game's already lost to the other side.

The universal popularity of the game also means you don't have to have a LAN party just to play it, and you can always find freely-available servers and players at any time of day or night, provided you have a decent Internet connection. The game does require at least a 256 Kbps connection if you are to have any chance of fragging some of the more experienced players.

The success of this game spawned a single-player follow-up in 2004—*Counter Strike: Condition Zero*. This game was very much like the original CS, except you had no choice but to be the good guy (a